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SYSTEMS AND METHODS FOR CONTROLLING OPERATION OF AN ARTICLE BASED ON DETECTION OF AN INTERACTION EVENT

Abstract

Disclosed herein are systems, methods, and non-transitory computer-readable storage media for detecting events occurring to an article at a remote location using low-power event detection circuitry and transmission of event detection messages over a network.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/492,109, filed Oct. 23, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/841,607, filed Apr. 6, 2020 which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/639,983, filed Mar. 5, 2015, which claims benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 61/949,935, filed Mar. 7, 2014 and to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/040,966, filed Aug. 22, 2014 of which are incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

BACKGROUND

1. Technical Field

[0002] The present technology relates to the field of networking and consumer electronics, and more specifically, to systems and methods for enabling interactions with consumers and consumer articles, such as a package, via telecommunications networks.

2. Introduction

[0003] Presently, tracking events remotely involves humans manually notating that an event occurred. For example, a receptionist can sign for a package and the courier can send a confirmation to the sender of the package that the package was received. However, the sender never actually knows that the package was opened. Likewise, consumer goods (e.g. medicine containers, tires, light bulbs, etc.) are passive and require a human to report that they need replacement or servicing. More advanced systems and methods are required to detect events at remote locations.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0004] In order to describe the manner in which the above-recited and other advantages and features of the disclosure can be obtained, a more particular description of the principles briefly described above will be rendered by reference to specific embodiments thereof which are illustrated in the appended drawings. Understanding that these drawings depict only exemplary embodiments of the disclosure and are not therefore to be considered to be limiting of its scope, the principles herein are described and explained with additional specificity and detail through the use of the accompanying drawings in which:

[0005] FIG. 1 schematically illustrates an event detection and remote communications device embedded in an article, in accordance with some embodiments of the present technology;

[0006] FIG. 2 illustrates network architecture for remote detection and operation of the article, in

accordance with some embodiments of the present technology;

[0007] FIG. 3 illustrates network architecture for remote detection and operation of the article, in accordance with some embodiments of the present technology;

[0008] FIG. 4 is a flow chart for establishing communications with the article, in accordance with some embodiments of the present technology;

[0009] FIG. 5 is a flow chart for establishing communications with the article, in accordance with some embodiments of the present technology;

[0010] FIG. 6 schematically illustrates coupling between icons on an article and one or more event detection systems, in accordance with some embodiments of the present technology;

[0011] FIG. 7 schematically illustrates a device for providing digital content to a user in lieu of live streaming, in accordance with some embodiments of the present technology;

[0012] FIG. 8 is a flow chart for provisioning digital content devices, and receiving content from same, in accordance with some embodiments of the present technology;

[0013] FIG. 9 is a flow chart for assigning network identifiers to articles in accordance with some embodiments of the present technology; and

[0014] FIG. 10 is a flow chart for obtaining control of an article remotely in accordance with some embodiments of the present technology.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0015] Various embodiments of the disclosure are discussed in detail below. While specific implementations are discussed, it should be understood that this is done for illustration purposes only. A person skilled in the relevant art will recognize that other components and configurations may be used without parting from the spirit and scope of the disclosure.

[0016] The present disclosure addresses the need in the art for more advanced approaches for detecting events at remote locations. Systems, methods, and computer-readable media are disclosed which detect events occurring to an article at a remote location. The technology can involve integrating communication system within an article or package. The communication system can include a memory, a low-power power source, a sensor for detecting an interaction event with the article, a microcontroller coupled with the sensor, and a communication interface coupled with the microcontroller. The communication system can be associated with a telecommunication network (cellular network, mobile virtual network operator network (MVNO), pager network, long range radio network, ad-hoc event detection network, etc.) and can be assigned a network identifier and an article identified.

[0017] When the article or package is sent to a remote location and the sensor detects a predetermined event (opening the package, detecting a threshold luminosity, detecting a threshold pressure) the communication system can send a message over the telecommunication network that includes the network identifier, the article identifier, and location information (e.g. cell tower location).

[0018] The technology can further involve an operating server (e.g. a server operated by an interchange entity such as an MVNO) receiving the message and recording the occurrence of the event at the location it occurred. The interchange entity can also provision article identifiers for tracking articles and packages. Similarly, the interchange entity can acquire bulk bandwidth for communicating over the telecommunication network and can provision articles and packages with network identifiers associated with a portion of the bandwidth to allow the telecommunication network to permit messages to be sent to the operating servers.

[0019] In the following description, for the purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the present technology. It will be apparent, however, that the present technology may be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, well-known structures and devices are shown in block diagram form in order to avoid unnecessarily obscuring the present technology.

[0020] FIG. 1 illustrates an event detection system 100 for providing event detection data relating

to a consumer article over a network according to some embodiments of the present technology. The event detection system **100** can be coupled with an article **101**, such as, for example, a package. Other examples of an article include envelopes, paper, books, magazines, shipping packages, package wrapping, gift wrapping, consumable items, price tags, price labels, theft-deterrent devices, inhalers, tires, clothing material, clothing tags, clothing labels, computing devices, consumer devices, such as an LED or other light-emitting fixture, disposables such as bottles or other containers for food products, liquids, toiletries, or other replenishables or perishables, off-the-shelf sensors such as temperature sensors or light sensors, automotive goods such as tires, batteries, and auto parts, or any portable object.

[0021] The event detection system **100** can also include a power source **102**, a sensor **103**, a communication system **104**, an antenna **106**, a microprocessor **108**, and memory **114**. The event detection system **100** can also include additional power storage **112**, an actuator **110**, and other mechanisms **116**. The components of the event detection system **100** shown in FIG. **1** and similar components are explained in more detail below.

[0022] In some embodiments, the event detection system **100** may be housed on a substrate or within one or more substrates. The substrates can be attached to or enclosed within packages or other consumer articles. The substrates can be distinct from the packages and can be integrated within the packages. Examples of packages on which the event detection system **100** could be attached include paper-based packages such as envelopes, printed materials such as menus, or packaging such as pizza boxes. A variety of other packages and consumer articles can benefit from the present technology and a number of types of packages and articles are mentioned explicitly in this disclosure. However, those with ordinary skill in the art having the benefit of this disclosure will readily appreciate that a wide variety of packages and articles can be used with the present technology.

[0023] In some embodiments, the event detection system **100** is implemented in one or more integrated circuits, which may include silicon-based integrated circuits, and in which the event detection system **100** may be attached to the packages via an adherent. The event detection system **100** can be enclosed within the package, such as, by way of illustrative example but not limitation, an envelope or pizza box. In some embodiments, the electronics comprising the event detection system **100** may be deposited, in whole or in part, on the medium of the package itself. For instance, the components of the event detection system **100** may be instantiated directly on a paper-based medium, such as an envelope or cardboard box.

[0024] In embodiments of the present technology, the event detection system **100** is substantially visually indistinguishable from the medium in which it is embedded or attached. For example, when the event detection system **100** is attached to or embedded in a paper envelope, the event detection system **100** may be visually indistinguishable to viewers from the paper of the envelope. It will be understood by those skilled in the art that the technology can be practiced on media that are durable rather than disposable, and that in alternative embodiments of the present technology, the features of the present technology described herein are implemented in durable materials, substrates, or other non-disposable media.

[0025] As explained above, the event detection system **100** includes a power source **102**. In embodiments of the technology, the power source **102** is an ambient power source, which receives and converts energy from the surrounding environment. For example, the ambient power source may be a photo-voltaic detector. In other embodiments, the power source **102** may obtain energy from radio waves or other electromagnetic spectrum. Ambient energy sources may include inductive power sources, such as those powering RFID readers.

[0026] Also some embodiments of the present technology can involve using thermal power, such as from body heat, or ambient kinetic energy, such as from the motion of a user or recipient of the package. Alternative forms of ambient energy that can be utilized to supply power to the event detection system **100** will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0027] In some embodiments, the power source **102** can be a lightweight battery. Certain embodiments may utilize a capacitor for energy storage. For example, a supercapacitor may be utilized. In some embodiments, the capacitors or battery may be on a separate substrate from the event detection system; in other embodiments, the capacitor or battery may be implemented within the physical medium of the event detection system, such as in paper on a paper-based package.

[0028] In other embodiments, there is no battery or power storage in the event detection system, and all power is received through ambient sources. Some embodiments of the present technology include additional secondary power storage **112** that is separate from the original power source; in some such embodiments, the secondary power storage **112** collects power from a primary power source **102** from time-to-time, or on a periodic basis.

[0029] In embodiments of the present technology, the power source **102** is utilized to provide a signal of an event to the event detection system **100**, as described further in other sections of this written description. In embodiments of the present technology, the power source **102** is charged prior to delivery of the event detection system **100**, so that the event detection system **100** is operable immediately without requiring power from an external source for initial communications to be conducted via the communications system **104**.

[0030] As explained above, the event detection system **100** can include a communications system **104**. In some embodiments of the present technology, the communications system **104** communicates over a long-distance wireless telecommunications system. For example, the wireless telecommunications system can be a pager network. In some embodiments of the present technology, the telecommunications system does not require a SIM card or other similar local network identifier to be included in the event detection system **100**. Also, the wireless telecommunications system can be a cellular network, such as a TDMA, CDMA, LTE or GSM network. Other alternative wireless telecommunications systems that can be utilized with the present technology will be apparent to those skilled in the art. Additionally, the communications system **104** may communicate over a wireless local area network (e.g. 802.11 protocol). Other alternative wireless network systems that can be utilized with the present technology will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0031] In certain embodiments, the communications system **104** may include systems to communicate within close proximity to other devices, such as Near Field Communications (NFC), Bluetooth, or radio frequency identification (RFID) systems; other such systems for proximate communications will be apparent to those skilled in the art. The communications system **104** may include an antenna **106**. In certain embodiments, the antenna **106** may be a strip line antenna; in certain embodiments, the antenna may be printed on the same medium as the package, such as paper. In some embodiments, the communications system **104** may include a Subscriber Identity Module (SIM) circuit. Alternative implementations of the communications system **104** that are operable at the voltages provided by the power source **102** will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0032] In embodiments, the event detection system **100** includes a low power microcontroller/microprocessor **108**, which is operable under the power provided by the power source. For example, the microcontroller **108** may constitute an 8-bit microcontroller; however, in other cases, higher-bit microcontrollers may be utilized. The microcontroller **108** will be operable at a power and voltage that can be supplied by the power source **102**. In some such embodiments, the microcontroller **108** is in communication with solid state, low-power non-volatile memory **114** that can be embedded on the substrate, and that is operable at the power and voltage that can be supplied by the power source **102**. The non-volatile memory **114** may in embodiments, be readable, programmable, or read/writeable. Suitable forms of non-volatile memory **114** will be apparent to those skilled in the art. In embodiments of the present technology, the digital components of the event detection system **100** are coupled over one or more communications buses; in some such embodiments, such one or more communications buses may be embedded in a common substrate

with other components of the event detection system **100**.

[0033] The microcontroller **108** will also be configured to operate the communications system **104**, in response to events detected by the event detection system **100**. In some embodiments, the power source **102** also serves as a sensor that detects events which are reported to the microcontroller **108**. As an illustrative, non-limiting example, the microcontroller **108** may be programmed to detect when a photo detector acts as a power source **102** in the event detection system **100** and receives light at a certain luminosity, and may be configured to send a signal via the telecommunications system **104** in response. In alternative embodiments, the event detection system **100** includes a sensor **103** that is separate from the power source **102**, wherein the sensor **103** is in communication with the microcontroller! microprocessor **108**, and the microcontroller! microprocessor **108** is operative to poll and respond events detected at the sensor **103**. In some embodiments of the present technology, the event detection system **100** includes an on-board actuator **110** in communication with the microcontroller/microprocessor **108**, to drive other mechanisms **116** that are coupled to the actuator **110**, in response to commands received from the microcontroller! microprocessor **108**. For example, the actuator **110** may be coupled to and operate an LED **116** attached to the event detection system **100**. In some cases, the LED can be Organic LEDs (OLEDs) or quantum dots. Other examples of actuators that can be used in embodiments of the present technology will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0034] In some embodiments, the mechanism **116** may be a small, lightweight display, such as a liquid crystal display. In some such embodiments, the display **116** may be utilized to display a code, such as a QR code. In some embodiments, the mechanism **116** may be a speaker. In some such embodiments, the speaker may be utilized to issue an audible or inaudible sound that identifies the event detection system **100** or package **101**.

[0035] In some embodiments, the actuator **110** and output mechanism **116** may also act as sensors **103**; in some such embodiments, a speaker **116** may also be utilized as a microphone that provides input to the sensor **103/110**, which translates the analog signal of the microphone into a digital signal for the microcontroller **108**. Other mechanisms **116** attached to the packaged that maybe operated by the actuator **110** will be apparent to those skilled in the art. In some embodiments, the event detection system includes an actuator **110**, but no sensor **103**; in some such embodiments, the actuator **110** is responsive to signals received by the microprocessor/microcontroller **108** via the communication system **104**.

[0036] FIGS. **2** and **3** illustrate examples of communications networks used for remote interaction with articles containing event detection systems according to some embodiments of the present technology. As shown in FIGS. **2** and **3**, multiple articles **299** containing event detection systems can communicate over long-distances over a long-range wireless communications system **200**. For example, the wireless communications system **200** can be a pager network, a cellular network, or other wireless communications system, which is communicable via a lower power system, as discussed above. In some embodiments of the present technology, the wireless communications system **200** can include two or more wireless networks from different telecommunications services providers. For example, different telecommunications services providers and networks may be utilized for communications with the article **299** if the article **299** moves in and out of coverage, roams between networks, etc.

[0037] In some embodiments of the present technology, an article **299** can communicate with one or more communications servers **202**. In some such embodiments the communications servers **202** are configured to identify one or more network identifiers associated with the article **299** via a device identification database **204** coupled locally to the communications servers **202**. In some other embodiments, as depicted in FIG. **3**, the identification database **204** is remote from the communications servers **202**.

[0038] In embodiments, the communications servers **202** include protocol gateways for transforming messages received via the wireless communications system **200** to a packet based

protocol for further distribution over the wide area network **208**, as described below.

[0039] Embodiments of the present technology include one or more operating servers **206** for interacting with the articles **299**; such interactions may include monitoring and/or operating the articles **299**. In embodiments of the present technology, the operating servers **206** are in communication with the communications servers **202** via a wide area network **208**, such as the Internet. Also, communications between the operating servers **206** and the articles **299** can be sent over a packet-switched protocol, such as or TCP/IP or UDP. In some embodiments, the packet-switched protocol is IPv4 or IPv6. Other packet-switched protocols that may be utilized for communications between the articles **299** and the operating services **206** shall be apparent to those skilled in the art. In some embodiments, the one or more operating servers **206** are in direct communication with the device identification database **204**.

[0040] In some embodiments of the present technology, the communications system **104** associated with an article is configured not to search for cellular towers at periodic intervals; rather, the communications system **104** can be configured to send a burst communication to reach multiple cellular towers upon the occurrence of an interaction event upon which an individual message is to be sent. Also, the communications system **104** can be configured so that a message is held by the processor **108** and only sent by the communications system **104** once sufficient power is received/stored at the power source **102** to enable a one-time delivery of the message to the communications server **202** via the communications system **200**.

[0041] In some embodiments of the present technology, an article is associated with one or more network identifiers. For example, the network identifiers can include an identifier on the telecommunications network **200**, such as a telephone number. In some embodiments, the one or more network identifiers may include an identifier such as an IP address (such as an IPV4 or IPv6 address), a MAC address, or a universally unique identifier (UUID). Other examples of network identifiers associated with the articles will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0042] In embodiments of the present technology, a single article may include more than one event detection system **100** and each of the one or more event detection systems **100** shares one or more of the network identifiers. For example, an envelope may have two or more event detection systems **100**, each of which has the same phone number. In some embodiments, the event detection systems **100** are authenticated to the communications server **202** only if all event detection systems **100** on the device report the same identifier.

[0043] In embodiments of the present technology, the identification database **204** maps the network identifiers to the one or more articles. In some embodiments, the identification database also records one or more individuals associated with an article. In embodiments, other personally identifying information may be included in the identification database **204**, such as a postal address for the user, or to which a package is sent. Other examples of user or article information that may be stored in the identification database **204** shall be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0044] The identification database can be an SQL database, a flat file, a CSV, or, distributed file system, etc. In certain embodiments, the identification database stores records in encrypted format. In some such embodiments, the encrypted records are only accessible by a user associated with the article. In certain embodiments, the user may access the identification database **204** via a web browser or other client application **210** in communication with the identification database **204** via the wide area network **208**. In some embodiments, the client application **210** may be a mobile application that operates on a smartphone, tablet, or other mobile computing device. In some such embodiments, communication between the client **210** and the identification database **204** is over a secure protocol, such as, by way of example but not limitation, Secure Socket Layer; other suitable secure protocols will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art. In some embodiments, the identification database **204** and client **210** are configured to allow the user to set up a password unique to the user, which is required for operating the articles remotely.

[0045] In certain embodiments, the network identifier of an article includes several more bits than

necessary to uniquely identify the article, for purposes of security and/or error correction. In some such embodiments, the bits in the network identifier are randomized. In some embodiments, a plurality of event detection systems **100** on a single package include a common string in the network identifier, to indicate that such event detection systems **100** belong on a single package. In certain embodiments, the network identifier includes error correction, such as forward error correction, Hamming codes, or Reed-Solomon codes. Other methods of error correction or redundancy that may be applied to the network identifiers shall be readily apparent to those skilled in the art. In certain embodiments, the event detection system **100** may be communicated with by the operating server **206** via email, SMS, Twitter, or other text-based messaging systems. In some embodiments, the event detection system **100** is associated with a public key, for encrypting and authenticating keys

[0046] FIG. **4** illustrates an example for authenticating packages or other articles containing communication systems according to some embodiments of the present technology. The method **400** can involve a communication system **100** detecting an event (e.g. interaction event) at an article **402**. By way of example but not limitation, the event may be an initial detection that a threshold of energy has been received at the power source **102**, or that another event has been detected at a sensor **103** separate from the power source **102**. As a non-limiting example, the power source **102** may be a photo-diode, and the microcontroller **108** may be initially configured in a sleep state, and subsequently enclosed or embedded in an enclosed package, such as an envelope or cardboard box. The microcontroller **108** may be configured to wake when a power source **102** reaches a certain threshold of energy, such as, by way of example but not limitation, a certain luminosity arriving at the photo-diode by virtue of the enclosure being opened by an end user, or a certain current or voltage threshold being received or produced at the power source **102**.

[0047] Alternatively, the event detection system **100** may be charged initially with power, and may be configured to periodically poll one or more ports or sensors **103** in order to determine if an event has occurred, such as the breaking of a circuit. As an illustrative, non-limiting example, the event detection system **100** could be enclosed in a package such as an envelope or box, and the event could be the breaking of a circuit, for example, when the enclosure is opened. Other examples of such triggering events will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0048] The method **400** also involves the article communicating **404** with the communication server **202** in response to the event, e.g. via a telecommunications system.

[0049] In some embodiments of the present technology, at the time that the article is deployed, bandwidth may be purchased from the providers of a telecommunications service, in order to allow the article communicate via the telecommunications service **200** automatically, for a minimum or perpetual subscription period. Alternatively, such connectivity may be purchased from the providers of the telecommunications service **200** in batches, allowing communication from the packages for limited periods of time.

[0050] Next, the method **400** involves, upon receipt of communication from the event detection system containing an identifier for the article, the communications server checking the identifier **406** against a local article identification database **204** to authenticate the identification of the article, and establish communication **408** with the article. If the article identifier is not authenticated **410**, the communication is dropped. For example, if the identifier is not authenticated, such identifier may be placed on a blacklist in the local article identification database **204**, so that future communications are not received from such article identifier.

[0051] FIG. **5** illustrates an exemplary method **500** for authenticating an article with an article identification database **204** using an operating server **206** according to some embodiments of the present technology. In such embodiments, after the triggering event is detected **502** at the article, the article establishes communication **504** with the communications server via the communications network. The communications server then encapsulates one or more identifiers received from the article in one or more packet payloads **506**. The communications server forwards the encapsulated

packets to the operating server via the packet-switched network **508**. In some embodiments, the encapsulated packet is forwarded to the operating server in an encrypted or secure form. In some such embodiments, such communications are conducted using a Secure Socket Layer protocol, and/or by use of the IPSec protocol suite; other alternative security protocols that can be utilized for communications between the communications server and the operating server will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0052] On receipt, the operating server de-encapsulates the article identifier, and authenticates **510** the article identifier against the article identifier database. Upon authentication, the operating server establishes **512** a session with the article (or alternatively, is now configured to accept and exchange asynchronous messages with the article) over a packet switched protocol, with such messages routed to the article via the communications server **202** and the telecommunications network. In embodiments of the present technology, subsequent communications between an operating server **206** and the article are conducted over a secure protocol, such as a Secure Socket Layer protocol, IPSec, etc. In some such embodiments, secure communications sessions are established between the article and the device operating server **206**, so that such communications are not transparent to the communications servers **202**.

[0053] In embodiments of the present technology, the operating server **206** collects and generates reports and/or performs analytics on data received from and about the article. In some embodiments, the operating server **206** sends commands to the article to operate the article. In some embodiments, the reports are delivered by the operating server **206** to the client application **210**. In some embodiments, the client application **210** may also provide instructions to operate the article via the operating server **206**. In some embodiments, a user of the article may be authenticated and authorized to operate the article and/or receive data from the article via the client **210**.

[0054] In embodiments of the present technology, the functions and systems described above may be performed or operated, as applicable, by different entities. For example, one or more articles including an event detection system may be sent by or on behalf of one or more issuers to the end users. An issuer may utilize an interchange entity, such as for example, a telecommunications network provider, Mobile Virtual Network Operator (MVNO), a legacy network, such as a pager communication network, postal service, mail courier, retailer (storefront or online), delivery service, and the like for functions associated with the articles. In some such embodiments, the interchange is responsible for operating the operation servers **206**. In some embodiments, the interchange creates, operates and maintains the article identification databases **204**. In some embodiments, the interchange is responsible for the procurement of bandwidth from one or more telecommunications services providers of the telecommunications systems **200**. e.g. when the communications servers are operated by the telecommunications services providers. In some embodiments, as depicted in FIG. 2, the article identifier database **204** is operated by the telecommunications services provider. Also, the article identifier database **204** is operated by the interchange, as shown in FIG. 3. Identifiers for the applicable issuer and interchange may be included in the communications system **104**.

[0055] In some such embodiments, the interchange utilized for a package **101** is responsible for routing communications from an article to the appropriate issuers via the network identifier of the article. In some such embodiments, upon receiving or exchanging messages from or with an article, the interchange updates billing records associated with the issuer, or accounts payable to the telecommunications services provider. In some embodiments, the operation servers **206** may be operated or accessed by the issuer, and communications between the issuer and the articles are routed by the interchange to the appropriate telecommunications services provider by reference to the article/network identifiers. In some embodiments, an issuer may utilize different interchanges for communications with different articles or different types of articles. For example, an issuer may communicate with articles via different interchanges which are selected or determined based upon

the geographical destination of the article or location of the intended user/consumer. Alternatively, interchanges may be selected or determined based on the bandwidth required for communication with the applicable article, the type of communications to be conducted with the articles, or the applications supported by the articles. Those with ordinary skill in the art having the benefit of this disclosure will readily appreciate that other a wide variety of criteria can be used for selection of interchanges.

[0056] In some embodiments of the present technology, the network identifier for an article is loaded on to the communications system **104** at the time the article or package is provisioned. For example, the identifier may be loaded in a SIM circuit in the communications system **104**. The telecommunications provider can route traffic between the article and the article operating servers **206** that are operated by or on behalf of the issuer of the article or package, based on the network identifier for the article. When communications between the operating server **206** and the event detection system **100** are held over secure communication sessions, such communications will not be transparent to the telecommunications services provider.

[0057] In embodiments of the present technology, the article identification database **204** is populated at the time the article and/or packages are provisioned. In some embodiments, as depicted in the flowchart in FIG. **9**, at the time of provisioning, the package is sent **900** through an automated process whereby information printed on the package is read **902**. For example, a reader reads such printed information via optical scanning. The printed information may be a name of an intended recipient of the package and a delivery address for the package. Thereafter, the articles that are enclosed in or attached to the package are detected **904**. For any article that has not been provisioned in an article identification database **906**, the article is read to see if it has an identifier encoded **908**.

[0058] If not, an article identifier is selected from a pool of available identifiers and scanned onto the article **910**. If there is an identifier on the article, that identifier is retrieved **912** and stored in the article identification database **204** along with the associated name and location of the intended package recipient **914**.

[0059] In alternative embodiments, as will be apparent to those skilled in the art, the steps in the foregoing process may be conducted concurrently or in alternative orders. By way of example but not limitation, the article may be detected initially, with the label/delivery address placed on the package based on the identifier of the article. In other embodiments, the article is not scanned, but the article identifier may be known by virtue of an order in which the package was sent through the process. In some embodiments, the package may be initiated through the process without an identifier for the article or a package label, and both may be assigned to the article and its applicable package concurrently. Other variants will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0060] As will be apparent to those skilled in the art, the articles described herein can constitute a consumer device, such as an LED or other light bulb or fixture, disposables such as bottles or other containers for food products, liquids, toiletries, or other replenishables or perishables, off-the-shelf sensors such as temperature sensors or light sensors, automotive goods such as tires, batteries, or auto parts; additional examples are too numerous to mention, but will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art. Certain such media, or goods, have states to be monitored by either the user via a client **210**, or by a vendor or other entity in communication with the article and event detection system **100** via an operating server **206**.

[0061] In embodiments of the present technology, an article or package is monitored automatically and remotely via an operating server, without requiring provisioning or other manual intervention by the user. For example, an article may be a medicine bottle that is delivered to a user, whereby an event corresponds to detection of an amount of medicine remaining in the bottle. By way of illustration, the bottle may be configured such that multiple measurements, such as weight measurements, or detection of fluid levels, are taken by the event detection system **100**, in order to determine robustly that an amount of medication has fallen below a defined threshold, with the

multiple measurements taken in order to minimize false-positive results. In embodiments of the present technology, a delivery of refills for the medication is dispatched to the location of the bottle upon when notification of the threshold is received at the operating server, and a determination is made by the operating server that the result is robust and the medicine has definitively fallen below a designated threshold. For example, the medicine may be an inhaler, and the triggering event may be a determination of pressure in the inhaler, or detection of a certain gas mixture in the inhaler, indicating a need for replenishment. The foregoing information may also be correlated and stored with other medical records of the applicable users. Other examples of such replenishables shall be readily apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0062] The event detection system **100** may be used in conjunction with an automobile tire, and a triggering event can correspond, for example, to a dramatic pressure drop, and a message is sent by the event detection system **100** to an operating server indicating the drop in tire pressure and a geolocation of the automobile. In embodiments of the present technology, the power source **102** of the event detection system **100** is a separate power source from the car battery. For example, the power source may derive from heat sources or kinetic sources in the car, or from alternative redundant power sources in the car. In some such embodiments, the geolocation of the event detection system is separate from geolocation systems in the car or otherwise. For example, the geolocation data may be inferred from telecommunications networks **200** by which the event detection system **100** communicates. In embodiments of the present technology, upon detecting a catastrophic failure of the tire and receiving the geolocation of the automobile, an operating server can automatically dispatch service to the location of the event detection system **100**. As will be apparent to one skilled in the art, the present technology can be similarly utilized for event detection system **100** included in an automobile battery, where the triggering event corresponds to a voltage indicating a battery failure. Other examples will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0063] In some embodiments of the present technology, an article, package, and system are also remotely operable, by the user via the client **210**, or by a third party via an operating server **206**, as further depicted in the flowchart in FIG. **10** For example, a package may be a light source, such as an LED, whereby the light source is provisioned, prior to delivery to the user, with sufficient call-time to exchange messages via a wireless telecommunications network for the expected life of the product. In some such embodiments, the event detection system is bound by an identifier that is provided to the user. For example, the identifier may be included in packaging for the product. Alternatively, the product may be configured to communicate with a mobile device of the user via a near field protocol, such as NFC, and to be bound by an identifier set by the user. In some such embodiments, after receipt **1000** of the package the user may enter **1002** the article identifier/credentials included in the package into the client device. The user is then authenticated by an article operating server **206** by use of the credentials **1004**. If the user is authenticated **1006**, the user is then granted authorization **1008** to control the article or package, including rights to receive data from sensors **103** and control actuators **110**. In some embodiments, the user is granted authority to remotely monitor and operate the article via the client **210**. In embodiments of the present technology, after authentication of the user, the user may transfer authority **1010** to operate the article to a third party. In some such embodiments, such transfer may be effectuated through a third party login/authorization system (such as, by way of example but not limitation, Facebook Connect; other alternatives will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art) and the article identifier database **204** is updated with the credentials for the third party **1012**.

[0064] For example, when the article is an electronic device, the user may reduce a luminosity of the device remotely via a client. As another example, the package may be a thermostat, and the user may obtain authorization to obtain data from the thermostat and operate the thermostat remotely after authentication using codes on the package that are submitted to the article operating server by the user. Other examples/embodiments of such remote authentication and operation of article and

packages will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0065] In some embodiments, the article can be wearable by a user. By way of example but not limitation, an article may constitute a button embedded into clothing or jewelry, whereby, by pressing the button, a call is immediately placed to an emergency number. In some such embodiments, the user may communicate with the emergency responders audibly, through a microphone/speaker in communication with the event detection system. In some such embodiments, the call is placed directly via the cellular network **200**. In other embodiments, a call center talks to the emergency responders based on data delivered from the article.

[0066] In an embodiment of the present technology, the event detection system **100** is embedded/attached to a mobile device, such as a cellular phone, laptop, tablet, etc. In some such embodiments, the event detection system **100** can be embedded on such device in a manner that is inconspicuous, or that cannot be detached physically from the device without destruction/mutilation of the device. In some such examples, the event detection system **100** communicates over a wireless telecommunications system **200** that is separate from the antenna and communications system of the mobile device. In some such embodiments, the event detection system **100** has an ambient power source separate from that of the mobile device, so that the phone periodically reports its location to the operating server **206**, separately from the mobile device itself, so that its location can continue to be tracked in case the mobile device itself is wiped or runs out of power.

[0067] In some embodiments, the event detection system **100** is attached to consumer good articles at the time of production, prior to delivery to stores, as a means of theft detection. By way of example but not limitation, the event detection system **100** may be attached to a consumer article, such as an article of clothing, at the time of manufacture, and provisioned with sufficient bandwidth/“talk-time minutes” on a telecommunications network to send its location to the operating server **206** for a period of time that is substantially longer than the expected sales cycle for the consumer good. On initial receipt of a location that is outside of the permitted stores to which the consumer good can be delivered, the operating server can check a database to determine whether or not the article has been sold. If the article has not been sold, a theft alert is generated. Alternative data flows for fraud detection will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0068] In embodiments of the present technology, an event detection system **100** is provisioned by one or more separate devices/machines prior to delivery of a package to the end user. In some such embodiments, the one or more separate devices scan an address on the package at the time it is provisioned. This may include scanning a printed address via optical character recognition, scanning a bar code, QR code, or other such printed code on the package, and/or detection of the event detection system **100** via electronic communication, such as, by way of example but not limitation, via Near Field Communication. In some such embodiments, the machines update the article identifier database to couple the postal/physical delivery address on the package **101** (or other such identification of the package **101** as may be printed on the package **101** or indicated in the bar code, QR code, or other such code) with an article and/or user identifier in an article identifier database. Other mechanisms for correlating printed information on the package **101** with article identifiers or other information regarding the user or article will be apparent to those skilled in the art. In some embodiments, such separate articles may be operable to adhere and/or enclose the event detection system **100** particular positions on a package, for conformance with design specifications for the package, or to place articles in communication with corresponding icons on the package.

[0069] In embodiments of the present technology, the event detection system **100** is utilized to measure and track the interaction of the user with an article or package. In some such embodiments, the event **402** is a proxy indicating an interaction of the user with the article or package. By way of example but not limitation, the event **402** may indicate that the user touched an icon on the package **101**, such as, by way of illustrative example but not limitation, a printed

“button” on the package **101**.

[0070] As depicted in FIG. **6**, a package **101** may have one or more printed icons/sensors **602**, **604** that are in communication with one or more event detection systems **100** embedded in the package **101**. In some such embodiments, an event is triggered by breaking or completing a circuit by virtue of the user interaction. For example, the event detection system **100** may be configured so that, by virtue of touching the icon **602**, **604**, a circuit between the power source **102** and the remainder of the event detection system **100**. In other embodiments, the event detection system **100** includes touch detection at the icon **602**, **604**. In other embodiments, the event **402** corresponds to detection of light from the opening of an enclosed package, such as an envelope or box. Many alternative embodiments will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0071] In embodiments of the present technology, after the event detection system **100** has been authenticated, the occurrence of the event **402** is recorded at one or more operation servers **206**, and associated with an identifier of the article or package. In some such embodiments, the operation servers receive and records an identifier for the package **101**, one or more identifiers for the event detection systems **100** on the package **101**, identifiers for an intended, expected, or authenticated recipient or user of the package **101**, the time at which the event **402** occurred, a geo-location for the package **101** at the time of the event **101**, as identified automatically through the event detection system **100** (via location parameters determined from the communications system **200**, or, in other embodiments, a low-power geo-location system, such as a low-power Global Positioning System interface, included in the event detection system **100**), a postal address to which the package **101** was sent, purchases or other electronic transactions conducted by interaction with the icons, etc. In some embodiments, such information is stored in one or more databases, which may be relational databases or other distributed databases. In some such embodiments, multiple events and corresponding records are stored and identified with an individual user or physical address.

[0072] In some embodiments, following authentication of an article **511**, an interchange may elect to decline facilitation of communications between an issuer and the article, based on policies. By way of example but not limitation, such a policy may be based on a geo-location of the device, or a volume of data intended to be transmitted to the device, etc.

[0073] In some such embodiments, the packages **101** and icons **602**, **604** include marketing or promotional literature or materials. Some such embodiments are utilized for tracking the responses of users to marketing or advertising campaigns. By way of example but not limitation, events recorded in embodiments of the present technology include measuring the opening of envelopes or other packages in response to their contents; the opening or viewing of printed pages (e.g. views of a magazine advertisement); recording and measuring customer responses such as pushing an icon **602** **604**, which may be depicted as a “button” or may otherwise indicate that part of a package was touched. In some such embodiments, such data may be used for real-time, or asynchronous off-line optimization of marketing campaigns. In embodiments of the present technology, a geo-location of the event detection system **100** at the time of the customer interaction is determined; in some such embodiments, such geo-location data is tracked against the databases **204** to determine whether or not the interaction with the event detection system **100** was by the targeted user. Such determinations may be utilized, by way of example but not limitation, to determine or enhance the accuracy of success rates in direct mail applications.

[0074] In some embodiments, such information may be used to determine payments to third parties for marketing/advertising on a package, e.g. paying third parties based upon user interactions with the package or transactions conducted via the package. Such analytics may also include, by way of example but not limitation, determination of success rates for direct mail campaigns. In some embodiments, subsets of the packages **101** may be selected to estimate the applicable statistics by statistical sampling. Other examples of analytics made possible by the present technology will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0075] In some embodiments of the present technology, the event detection system **100** is operable

to communicate with a user via a mobile phone application via a short-range protocol (e.g. NFC, Bluetooth, etc.). In some such embodiments, the event may correspond to a detection by the event detection system **100** that the user's mobile phone is within a certain proximity of the event detection system **100**. For example, an event detection system **100** may be embedded in a package **100**, whereby the event detection system **100** triggers an event when the event detection system **100** detects via the NFC that a device with a specified identifier is within a distance threshold of the event detection system **100**, and the event triggers interaction between the event detection system **100** and the mobile device (e.g., communication of a message from the event detection system **100** to the mobile device via the NFC, for display on the mobile device).

[0076] In some embodiments, a package **101** includes two or more components that communicate via an NFC, whereby the event detection system **100** is operative to detect from the NFC signals when such two or more components are physically moved relative to one another. For example, such components may be located on opposite pages of a magazine, such that an event may correspond to a page of the magazine being turned. Alternatively, one such component may be on a detachable part of the package and another component is on a non-detachable portion, whereby the event detection system **100** is operative to detect that the applicable portion of the package has been detached. Other such implementations of multiple short-range radio components within a package will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0077] In embodiments of the present technology, the event detection system **100** is utilized to conduct electronic commerce transactions via the event detection system **100**, i.e., the package **101** may constitute a bill or an invoice, e.g. a cable bill or a credit card bill.

[0078] For example, a package in the form of a bill for cable television can include an event detection system **100** sent to a user's home, and can include the icons **602**, **604** that indicate options to enable a user to select purchases of cable television packages, which are indicated by the icons **602**, **604**. Also, the package **101** may be a credit card bill, and the icons **602**, **604** may indicate whether or not the user approves or wishes to dispute individual payments. In another example, an icon **602**, **604** on a credit card bill with an event detection system **100** incorporated therein may be used to indicate whether or not a credit card invoice should be deducted from a user's bank account. In other embodiments of the present technology, the package **101** may be an advertisement, for instance, in a publication such as a magazine, which enables the user to purchase advertised items by touching an icon **602**, **604**. In some such embodiments, the user's credit card information is stored on or is otherwise accessible by one or more article operating servers **206**, and purchases are allowed via the icons **602**, **604** after the user has been authenticated. In some such embodiments, communications between the event detection system **100** and the device operating servers **206** in connection with the transaction is conducted via encrypted protocols as described above.

[0079] As other examples, the packages **101** may be printed take-out/carry-out menus, or containers for food delivery, such as pizza boxes. In some such embodiments, the user may purchase an item for delivery via touching a corresponding icon **602**, **604**. In some such embodiments, a delivery service is reached via an operating server **206**, which receives an electronic message (e.g. an email, SMS, Twitter message, or other such electronic communication) from the event detection system **100** via the Internet. In other embodiments, the event detection system **100** places a telephone call to via the communications network **200** to the vendor. Some such embodiments may include miniature a microphone and/or speaker that attached to or part of the event detection system **100**, and is in communication with the microcontroller **108**; the microphone/speaker will be operable at the energies provided by the ambient power source **102**, and may be inconspicuous in or visually indistinguishable from the package **101**. Also, the microphone or speaker is used for vocal communication with the vendor via the communications network **200**. In some such embodiments, the transactions and fulfillment occur only after the postal address to which the package **101** was sent has been authenticated against one or more of the geo-location data from the event detection system **100** and/or an identifier for the user or event

detection system **100** that has been authenticated in accordance with embodiments of the present technology. In some examples, the purchased item is delivered in response to event, to the authenticated/validated physical/postal address of the package **101**.

[0080] Embodiments of the present technology support one-way, two-way, or multi-party vocal messages. In some embodiments of the present technology, the user may click on an icon **602**, **604**, or activate another event via the package, in order to send an audio message to a pre-determined recipient. For example, the recipient may be a vendor or a customer service representative. In embodiments of the present technology, following occurrence of the event, and provided that sufficient power is available from the power source **102**, a message is recorded from the user via the microphone on the package **101**. In some embodiments, this message is stored at the microprocessor **108** and/or communications processor **104** until there is sufficient power from the power source **102** to send the message via the communications system **200**. In some embodiments, the message is sent via the telecommunications system **200** automatically after recording.

[0081] In some embodiments, the event establishes direct communication with the recipient via the communications network **200** in real-time, without intermediate storage. In embodiments, the message from the user is forwarded to the recipient as an electronic message, such as an email, SMS, Twitter message, or other similar asynchronous electronic message. In some embodiments, the message is forwarded telephonically. In some embodiments, the communications system **104** in each of several packages **101** sent to different recipients may be pre-loaded with a call-in number or other identifier for a conference call, so that the recipients may establish and/or join the conference call via the telecommunications network **200** by clicking on the icon **602**, **604** or through another event at the package. In some embodiments of the present technology, prior to delivery of the package to the end user, charges for expected use of the telecommunications network **200** by the event detection system **100** have been pre-paid.

[0082] In embodiments of the present technology, an article or package is mailed to the user and the user is informed (via text on the package) that an event triggered by the user will indicate an assent by the user to a transaction. By way of illustrative example but not limitation, the text may state that the user will be charged for or will otherwise reimburse the postage or other delivery costs for the delivery of the package **101** to the user in the event of the user opening of the package, touching a corresponding icon **602**, **604**, etc. In some embodiments of the present technology, a message indicating that the user has assented to the charge is sent by the event detection system **100** to the operating server **206**, and the user is then charged separately. In other embodiments, upon the occurrence of the event, the user is automatically charged for the reimbursement, for example, by a charge to a credit/debit card or other on-line account that is previously stored for the user for access by the operating server **206**.

[0083] In some embodiments of the present technology, an article or package is physically mailed with pre-paid postal or delivery charges for return of the article or package to the sender. In some such embodiments, an article identifier for the event detection system **100** may be reutilized for the individual user to whom the article or package was sent, for use in subsequent deliveries to that user. Alternatively, following return of the original article or package, the article identifier can be decommissioned for the original user, and may be returned to a pool of available article identifiers.

[0084] In some embodiments, the user may indicate, via interaction with an icon **602** **604** or other event, that they are to receive a financial credit or reward on return of the article or package.

[0085] In some embodiments, the user can indicate, via the icon **602** **604** or other event at the package, that the package is to be collected, and a messenger may be dispatched to the user's location or postal address to collect the package **101** in response. Other variants for arranging return of an article or package via the event detection system **100** will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0086] Embodiments of the present technology comprise a storage device that includes a high-speed wireless cellular connection, whereby the storage device is preloaded with user content, and

the device is configured to release the user content by way of the cellular connection. Such embodiments are depicted schematically in FIG. 7. In embodiments of the present technology, the device **700** may be in a small form factor, such as a key fob or memory stick; other suitable form factors will be apparent to those skilled in the art. The device **700** includes one or more high capacity storage media **702**, such as, by way of example but not limitation, flash memory. Some embodiments of the present technology include a port **704**, which may be utilized for receiving power for the device **700**, and/or for transfer of the content resident in the storage media **702** to another device; by way of example but not limitation, the port may be a USB port. The device further includes a cellular communications system **706**. The cellular communications system **706** may, by way of example but not limitation, be a 4G system, such as LTE or Mobile WiMax; other alternatives will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0087] In embodiments of the present technology, the device **700** is configured to release content to an individual user, by virtue of one or more identifiers associated with the user. In embodiments of the present technology, a user may have content released from the device **700** by provisioning the applicable identifier to the device **700**. An example of the provisioning and utilization of the device **700** in accordance with such embodiments is depicted in FIG. 8. At the time of configuration, the device is loaded with one or more pieces of content **800**. Such content may be, by way of example but not limitation, movies or other video, songs, books, software, or other digital content that is generally streamed to an end user; other such content which can be delivered to a user by use of the device **700** will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art. As will be apparent to those skilled in the art, remote authentication steps described herein may alternatively be conducted locally on the device **700**.

[0088] In some embodiments, each such piece of content is associated with an identifier that is unique to the user, the content, and/or the device **802**, i.e. public keys. The device, content, and user identifiers are stored in a database **804**. The device is then physically shipped to the user **806**, associated with a user at the time of purchase or delivery of the device **700** to the user, etc. In some embodiments, the association, or binding, of the identifiers with the device may be conducted via an application running on a user's smartphone, whereby the instance of the application on the user has previously been authenticated. In alternative embodiments, such association/binding of the identifiers with the device **700** occurs at the point of sale, via a point of sale device in communication with the database **204** via the Internet **208**.

[0089] Following receipt of the device by the user **808**, the user may unlock the content on the device by providing the key for the applicable content to the device **810**. In some embodiments of the present technology, the key is automatically provided to the device **700** by another device; by way of illustration but not limitation, the ID may be provided by a television in communication with the device via the port **704** or the telecommunications system **706**. The key is sent by the device to a central server via the telecommunications system **812**. The key is authenticated by a central server **814**, and upon authentication, the central server grants a permission to the device **700** to release the applicable content to the user **816**. In embodiments of the present technology, contents are continually updated to the device by the central servers via the cellular system **706**, for potential later retrieval by a user. In alternative embodiments, the communications system **706** may be a low-bandwidth cellular communications system; in some such embodiments, the communications system is not utilized to update content to the device.

[0090] In certain embodiments, the devices are physically returned by the user to receive new content, whether loaded on the same device **700** or sent to the user in a new device **700**. Embodiments of the present technology include additional security measures for accessing or releasing content from a device **700**.

[0091] In embodiments of the present technology, in addition to authentication of the user/device/content identifiers, the geo-location of the device is determined, and the content is only released if the geo-location is approved for such device/content. In embodiments of the present

technology, such geolocation authentication is conducted at the remote database **204**; in alternative embodiments, the geo-location authentication is performed locally on the device **700**. In some embodiments, the geo-location is performed using telecommunications system on the device **700**. In alternative embodiments, the geo-location or alternative authentication utilizes short-range radio communications to a user's mobile device; examples of short-range radio protocols that may be used for such location include, by way of example but not limitation NFC, Bluetooth, RFIDs, beacons; etc. In other embodiments, the supplemental security measure may include biometric identification of the user by the device **700**.

[0092] In embodiments of the present technology, one or more devices **700** are utilized as a virtual local area network. In some such embodiments, each device constitutes a modem that can be attached to, or constitutes part of, hardware that would otherwise be connected to a local area network, such as a server, laptop computer, printer, router, desktop PC, etc. In some such embodiments, all communications amongst such machines, via a local networking protocol such as IEEE 802, or communications between such machines and the Internet, are conducted through the cellular system **708**; in some such embodiments, the local communication packets are encapsulated in the communications via the cellular system **710**.

[0093] In some such embodiments, the devices may also be coupled via a local mesh or other local network, where such local network is utilized solely for communications within the nodes on the network, and not for Internet communications. Embodiments of the present technology utilize the information collected from a user via an article or package **101** to personalize on-line, Internet and mobile-based content to such user; such customization may be conducted off-line or in real-time with the data received via the package **101**. For example an online identifier of the user which identifies the user's activities on the World Wide Web or elsewhere on the Internet (such as a persistent identifier stored in a cookie, login usernames for on-line services, mobile phone numbers, or other such on-line identifiers as will be apparent to those skilled in the art) may be correlated with identification of the package in the device identification database **204**. Web-based content may be customized for the user based on the data recorded about such user from a triggering event and their other interaction with the event detection system **100**. By way of example but not limitation, advertisements or other web-based or mobile content may be selected or customized for the user based on magazine contents that have been viewed by the user, as detected by the event detection system **100** and reported to the operating server **206**.

[0094] Alternatively, emails, texts, Twitter messages, or other such electronic messages may be sent to a user based on their interaction with the article or package, as detected and communicated by the event detection system **100**. By way of example but not limitation, a user may be sent a thank you note following interaction with the event detection system **100**. The package **101** may also be used by the end user (actively or passively) to update other records and workflows. By way of example but not limitation, health or insurance records of a user could be updated by way of the user's interaction with the event detection system **100**.

[0095] In embodiments of the present technology, analytics may be conducted on data sets contained in the database **204** which combine data from the users' on-line activities (e.g., their Web usage) with data regarding such users' interactions with article or packages. For example, the fees charged to advertisers may be based upon delivery or response to Web or mobile based ads served to users as well as response rates from such users to paper-based advertising, as the latter is detected and reported by the event detection system **100**. Other examples of integration of feedback of the event detection system **100** with user interactions via separate electronic media will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0096] In embodiments of the present technology, the actuator **110** may be coupled to mechanisms **116** such as a camera that is operable at the power provided by the supply **102**. In some such embodiments, the event detection system **100** is operable to take a picture of the user via the camera **116** when the user opens the package, and then transmit the picture over a wireless network

200. In some such embodiments, the picture is at a low-resolution, transmittable over low-baud rate networks. In embodiments, the picture may be utilized to authenticate the user, or provide proof that the individual opened the package. For example, for confirmation of service of process. Other uses and variants of such a camera will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0097] Some embodiments of the present technology include mechanisms for wirelessly detecting the presence of an article in the vicinity of the detection mechanism, in order to detect the presence of such a mechanism. In some such embodiments, the wireless detector checks for signature wireless transmissions in the vicinity that confirm the presence of an article or package. Such detection may be used by an individual to elect to dispose or destroy an article or package, or to open a package in an area that cannot transmit wireless signals (e.g., a Faraday cage).

[0098] In embodiments of the present technology include an application programming interface (API) that allow interactions with the event detection system **100** to be programmed or re-programmed. By way of example but not limitation, the API may allow the interactions from icons **602 604** to be programmed or reprogrammed, and result in different workflows. For example, the API may be utilized to program the event detection system **100** such that differing sequences of interactions with the icons **602, 604** result in different work flows being determined by the device operating servers **206**. As another illustrative example, the icons **602, 604** may have the visual effect of numbers on a keypad, and the API may be utilized in a first instance to allow the entry of certain numbers to lock or unlock a remote device that is in communication with the operating servers **206**; the API may subsequently utilized in an alternative program/instruction set that may be uploaded to the event detection system **100** via the telecommunications network **200**, whereby the revised instructions allow the user to operate an alternative device via the telecommunications network **200**. Many other examples of work flows that may be programmed by use of the API in accordance with the present technology will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art.

[0099] Although a variety of examples and other information was used to explain aspects within the scope of the appended claims, no limitation of the claims should be implied based on particular features or arrangements in such examples, as one of ordinary skill would be able to use these examples to derive a wide variety of implementations. Further and although some subject matter may have been described in language specific to examples of structural features and/or method steps, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to these described features or acts. For example, such functionality can be distributed differently or performed in components other than those identified herein. Rather, the described features and steps are disclosed as examples of components of systems and methods within the scope of the appended claims.

[0100] The various embodiments described above are provided by way of illustration only and should not be construed to limit the scope of the disclosure. Those skilled in the art will readily recognize various modifications and changes that may be made to the principles described herein without following the example embodiments and applications illustrated and described herein, and without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A method for controlling operation of an article, the method comprising: receiving, from an article and over a first wireless network, a communication including at least an article identifier, wherein the article includes an antenna for communicating and a sensor for detecting at least one interaction event; in response to receiving the communication, authenticating the article on a second wireless network based at least on the article identifier and a first set of credentials provided by a first device; granting, based on a second set of credentials, authority to enable the first device to control operation of the article; receiving, from a second device over a third wireless network, a request to control operation of the article, the request include a third set of credentials; granting,

based on the third set of credentials, authority for the second device to remotely control the operation of the article; receiving, from either the first device or the second device, a request to remotely control the operation of the article; and in response to receiving the request, remotely operating the article.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the first wireless network is a short range wireless network.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the first wireless network is a local network.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the second wireless network is a Wi-Fi network.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the second wireless network is a local network.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein the third wireless network is a Wi-Fi network.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the third wireless network is a telecommunications network.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein the at least one interaction event comprises an increase or decrease in voltage.

9. A system comprising: at least one processor; and at least one memory, storing instructions which when executed by the at least one processor, cause the system to: receive, from an article over a first wireless network, a communication including at least an article identifier, wherein the article includes an antenna for communicating and a sensor for detecting at least one interaction event; in response to receiving the communication, authenticate the article on a second wireless network based at least on the article identifier and a first set of credentials provided by a first device; grant, based on a second set of credentials, authority for the first device to control operation of the article; receive, from a second device over a third wireless network, a request to control operation of the article, the request including a third set of credentials; grant, based on the third set of credentials, authority for the second device to remotely control the operation of the article; receive, from either the first device or the second device, a request to remotely control the operation of the article; and in response to receiving the request, remotely operate the article.

10. The system of claim 9, wherein the first wireless network is a short range wireless network.

11. The system of claim 9, wherein the first wireless network is a local network.

12. The system of claim 9, wherein the second wireless network is a Wi-Fi network.

13. The system of claim 9, wherein the second wireless network is a local network.

14. The system of claim 9, wherein the third wireless network is a Wi-Fi network.

15. The system of claim 9, wherein the third wireless network is a telecommunications network.

16. The system of claim 9, wherein the at least one interaction event comprises an increase or decrease in voltage.
